M8 VENDOR GROUP MEETING

Meeting Date: September 30, 2026

Important Note: *This information is based on the information and circumstances provided at the date of publication and may change as new developments arise*

AGENDA

Discussion Topics:

- M8 Announcements
- Submitted Vendor Questions
- Open Discussion
- Next Steps

1. M8 ANNOUNCEMENTS

Discussion included updates to the ICH eCTD v4.0 webpage, including updates to the following specifications documents:

- IG Package v1.7
- CV Package v.1.03
- Q&A Document v.1.10

The implementation Status Table was updated in August and includes current regional implementation timelines for eCTD v4.0 for all regulators M8. Notes and slides from the last vendor group meeting were also posted on the ICH homepage.

2. SUBMITTED QUESTIONS AND RESPONSES

#	Questions and Answers – [action items are included for M8 IWG]
1	**eCTD4-055 and duplicate code/codeSystem pairs** **Q1: Should eCTD4-055 fail for the same sender-defined code and sender-defined codeSystem across different keyword types?** **Answer:** Yes **Q2: Does eCTD4-055 only check the sender-defined code's syntax and formatting?** **Answer:** No **Q3: Can a sponsor define two sender-defined keywords with the same code and codeSystem across different keyword types?** **Answer:** No

#	Questions and Answers – [action items are included for M8 IWG]
	No further questions or comments received.
2	**Concatenated Node Extension Delimiter** **Question: With respect to the portion of the Implementation Guide that requires nested node extensions from v3.2.2 to be mapped to a Group Title with the "_$" delimiter to separate/preserve the hierarchical relationship. Are there any specific ICH validation criteria that are expected to validate this requirement? Such as eCTD4-080?** **Answer:** Multiple impacted regions agree that there should be a validation pertaining to this requirement and are discussing how best to address. We welcome any input from the vendor community as we work toward aligning on a solution. **Other Discussion/Comments** • Mark Gray noted that when suspending a leaf you are only giving it a unique identifier so the node extension should not matter. In eCTD 4, node extensions and keywords should not be factored in. • Jan Wermusch posted the following observations in the meeting chat 1. When you want to replace study content from a 3.2 sequence in a 4.0 sequence, you use that group title pattern. But only if the study did not use STFs before (see number 3). The validation would then need to figure out whether the original leaf was in a node extension structure with precisely those titles. 2. When you want to add study content to a study that was started with a 3.2 sequence: Here you must also use that group title pattern if the study did not use STFs. But, technically, how would we know if the intention was to continue a study from 3.2 or to add to a new one? I think it is impossible. 3. The group title is allowed in a most of the sub-sections of module 3, 4 and 5. But checking its plausibility in FC context would apply to certain scenarios only. I'm afraid this will end up with many different interpretations by the tool vendors. ○ FDA uses the STF not the node extensions, however this will be discussed within the M8 group.
3	**UUID Case Sensitivity** **Question: Some eCTD validation tools currently compare UUIDs in a case-sensitive manner, meaning that a document defined with a lowercase UUID cannot be cross-referenced using the same UUID in uppercase. Can ICH provide clarification on how to handle UUIDs with respect to case?** **Answer:** • ITU-T X.667 (referenced in ICH eCTD v4.0 IG §4.5.2, fn. 10) explicitly requires processing software to accept both cases. • M8 has agreed to follow a harmonized approach to align with the above standard • Clarification to be made to ICH eCTD v4.0 IG or Q&A document stating UUID validation should be case-insensitive which will be consistent with the processing requirement in ITU-T X.667. **Other Discussion/Comments**

#	Questions and Answers – [action items are included for M8 IWG]
	• Jan Wermusch noted that the M8 Guidance states that the UUID needs to be kept as chosen during the full lifecycle. Jan asked if this is still relevant or if what we heard today takes precedence. ○ Kristiina Puusaari confirmed that UUID is not case sensitive. ○ Chris McCormick noted that this is only recently being addressed and discussed so there may be outdated documentation at the regional level, but this was discussed at the M8 level and all members were in agreement.

3. OPEN DISCUSSION

#	Additional Questions and Answers
1	**Question: Were any issues raised from industry regarding the regional forward compatibility pilots? Some pilot participants expressed concerns regarding tool availability in environments used to create test submissions.** No response from the vendor group on this item.
2	**Question: In CV packages there are context of use codes that don't reflect the eCTD structure and have items missing in the hierarchy. There is no hierarchy in eCTD for all the context of use as a list. When a heading is removed how should the tool vendors display the hierarchy going forward?** **Answer:** • When a heading is removed, the new submissions should not contain any documents under that removed heading. To display a document under the old heading, when no updates have been made to the heading, the expectation is that the users would still see the heading. • When someone switches from 3.2.2 to 4.0, they should be able to see what was submitted under both within the history of that tool. • In the viewing tool you should be able to see old content under the formally supported headings and for any new content the headings would no longer be supported. • For 4.0 there is no ICH level outline for the table of contents. The DTD laid this structure out when it related to 3.2.2. The DTD was a good reference for how submissions should be structured regarding the headings, but it was very rigid. ○ Mark Gray noted the M4 documents may show what the structure of the heading should be and suggested M8 discuss publishing a CTOC at an ICH level. ○ Aki Yamaguchi asked if the structures changes in the future how should we migrate from one structure to the next. • If regions are adding more granularity to the harmonized structure the vendors should consult the regulatory authority for that region. ○ Mark Gray noted that if other regulators are adding new context of uses, they should go through ICH for approval, otherwise it won't be harmonized. • If there's a history of sequences that have all been prepared using a single tool the recommendation would be to consult with the regional authority. ○ Luis Cunha noted that if there is customization to headings in modules 2-5 it should be consulted with ICH.

#	Additional Questions and Answers
	• The M8 group will conduct further discussions on these concerns.
3	**Question: clarification around center defined keyword OIDs. Are there any recommended standards for obtaining OIDs, any restrictions, or best practices?** Answer: • Companies are free to assign or create the OID or unique identifier when they are setting up the codesystem to define their keywords. However, they should not interfere with the existing registered ones. Should pick an identifier/OID that has not already been registered by any regional agency. • The company is free to choose the unique identifier, including OIDs. • The ICH Implementation Guide makes references to specific standards to follow and may help define these things.
4	**Question: the output folder structure for eCTD 4 is very flat. For multiple substances and multiple products in Module 3, can we still have multiple folders? Can there be different instances of the same subfolder?** **Answer:** • Yes, multiple instances of the same heading with different attributes would appear just as they would in eCTD 3.2.2.
	M8 reminded and requested that participants submit any further questions to the Vendor Group Mailbox (ICHM8Vendors@ich.org). .

Next meeting:

- **Winter – TBD:** Dependent on what questions are received in the Vendor Group Mailbox.

Future Meeting Agenda Topics:

1. New Topics/Questions from Vendors can be submitted to the Vendor Group Mailbox

Reminder: Any clarifications and/or recommended changes to the implementation specifications can be submitted as change requests.